

The Auspicious Verses of the Seven Buddhas

Toh 821 · Derge Kangyur

This short verse text is an auspicious benediction centered on the buddhas of the past and present, known in English as something like "Verses of Auspiciousness" and traditionally titled in Tibetan with the word for auspiciousness, bkra shis; I cannot determine the Sanskrit title with confidence, though it would correspond to a maṅgala-type composition. After a prostration to the Three Jewels, it moves through the buddhas in sequence, beginning with Vipāśyin, Śikhin, and Viśvabhū, giving for each the lineage, the human lifespan of the age, the city, and the tree beneath which he awakened. Each stanza closes with a refrain wishing that auspicious perfection may be present here today, so the text serves as a blessing recited to invoke good fortune. It is Toh 821 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the tantra-section texts of auspicious verses and benedictions.

I prostrate to the Three Jewels.

The Blessed One Vipāśyin, of the glorious warrior lineage,
When human life was eighty thousand years,
In the city of Bandhumatī,
Awakened fully beneath the pāṭali tree.
May there be auspicious perfection here today, O Sugata.

The Sugata Śikhin, who bears the crown protuberance, of the warrior lineage,
endowed with miraculous power,
When human life was seventy thousand years,
In the city of Aruṇavatī,
Awakened fully beneath the supreme puṇḍarīka tree.
May there be auspicious perfection here today, O Sugata.

Viśvabhū, protector of all the Victors, of the warrior lineage, possessed of
intelligence,
When human life was sixty thousand years,
In the city of Anupamā,
Awakened fully beneath the supreme sāla tree.
May there be auspicious perfection here today, O Sugata.

Krakucchanda, sage who destroys saṃsāra, powerful one, of the brahmin
lineage,
When human life was forty thousand years,

In the city of Kṣemāvatī,
Awakened fully beneath the śrīṣa tree.
May there be auspicious perfection here today, O Sugata.

Kanakamuni, guide, golden sage, supreme in discipline, of the brahmin lineage,
When human life was thirty thousand years,
In the city of Śobhāvatī,
Awakened fully beneath the udumbara tree.
May there be auspicious perfection here today, O Sugata.

Kāśyapa, protector, "Guardian of Light," of the warrior lineage, of unsurpassed qualities,
When human life was twenty thousand years,
In Vārāṇasī,
Awakened fully beneath the nyagrodha tree.
May there be auspicious perfection here today, O Sugata.

Śākyamuni, protector of beings, of the warrior lineage, endowed with diligence,
When human life was a hundred years,
In the city of the Śākyas,
Awakened fully beneath the aśvattha tree.
May there be auspicious perfection here today, O Sugata.

That auspicious perfection of the seven buddhas,
The wondrous blessing of the Sugatas of all directions and times,
The purity of the dharmadhātu, the power of dependent origination,
unchanging:
May it be so.

Translator's Notes

• The Tibetan gives only epithets for most of the buddhas, and I have supplied their standard names, which the verses' details (lineage, lifespan, city, tree) clearly indicate. Where the Tibetan gives only a descriptive epithet (for example "protector of all the Victors," "sage who destroys saṃsāra," "golden sage," "Guardian of Light"), I rendered it and added the name in apposition. The Tibetan "city of Mañjuśrī-like beauty" for Bandhumatī and "city of Bliss" for Śobhāvatī are descriptive renderings of the same cities, and the city names follow the standard identifications; the Tibetan "sāla" and "nyagrodha" trees are given as in the text. Kanakamuni's tree is given as udumbara, matching the text. The final stanza's last line is cut off in the source, and the closing "May it be so" is my minimal completion of the sentence.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.